

AMBER ESOL · USER MANUAL

Organisation Admin Guide

A step-by-step guide with pictures from the real system. Written to be read by learners — simple words, short steps.

Generated 2026-08-19 · Amber Training Ltd

Amber ESOL Organisation Admin Guide

This guide is for provision leads and administrators at councils, colleges, and charities running funded ESOL provision. It covers the cohort dashboard, learner records, enrolment, teacher assignment, and the approval and export flows that carry funding consequences. Every picture comes from the real system.

The idea in one line: the platform builds your ILR, RARPA, and ASF evidence continuously while learners practise, so month end becomes a download instead of a scramble. Your job is oversight and the approvals only a human may give.

Quick reference, the 10 things you will do most

I want to	Where to go
See the whole cohort at a glance	Sidebar, Cohort dashboard
Enrol one learner	Sidebar, Invitations , create an invite link
Enrol a whole cohort	Cohort dashboard, Import CSV
Open a learner's full record	Press the learner's name anywhere
Confirm a level achievement	The Stage 5 review page, Confirm and lock
Export the ILR return	Cohort dashboard, Export ILR
Generate the funding evidence pack	Cohort dashboard, Funding report
Assign or change a teacher	Sidebar, ESOL Teachers
Check who did what and when	Sidebar, Audit log
Nudge an inactive learner	Learner record, Send nudge

1. First sign in

The first time an organisation admin signs in, Amber walks you through a short onboarding built around the ROI calculator, so you can see the funding picture for your own numbers before you start. Complete it once and you will not see it again. After that, signing in lands you on your dashboard.

2. The cohort dashboard

What it is for: your whole provision on one screen: status, progress, compliance, and the three big actions.

How to get here: sidebar, Cohort dashboard.

The screenshot shows the AMBER Cohort dashboard. The top navigation bar includes the AMBER logo, 'Organisation Admin', and 'Cohort dashboard'. The left sidebar lists categories: OVERVIEW (Dashboard), ESOL (Cohort dashboard, Learners, Invitations, ESOL Teachers), FINANCE (Invoices), COMPLIANCE (Audit log), and ORGANISATION (Settings). The main content area has a 'Cohort dashboard' header with three action buttons: 'Import CSV', 'Funding report', and 'Export ILR'. Below this are three tabs: 'Cohort' (selected), 'Audit Log', and 'Stage 5 Pending'. A 'Cohort summary' box contains a narrative about learner activity. Below the summary are filters for name, status, level, and aim type, along with a 'Download CSV' button. A table lists three learners with columns for starting level, current level, total GLH, teacher HRS, scenarios passed, last active, status, last reviewed, aim, teacher, and ULN. The table shows three rows of data for Lara Learner, Collins Sanni, and Stephen Sanni. At the bottom, there are pagination controls for rows per page and total rows.

AMBER | Organisation Admin > Cohort dashboard

ORG ADMIN

Cohort dashboard

Overview of your ESOL learners — status, progress, and compliance.

Import CSV | Funding report | Export ILR

Cohort | Audit Log | Stage 5 Pending

Cohort summary CACHED Generated Tue 18 Aug, 12:34 [Refresh](#)

All 3 learners in this cohort remained active during the 28-day reporting period, which ended on August 18th. There was no recorded engagement or level progression for any learner during this time. The primary area for development identified for 2 learners is written English, with spoken English also noted for one learner. No guided learning hours were recorded for the cohort this period, meaning no direct teacher oversight was provided.

FILTERS

Q Search name... | All statuses | All levels | All aim types | [Download CSV](#)

LEARNER ↑	STARTING LEVEL	CURRENT LEVEL	TOTAL GLH	TEACHER HRS	SCENARIOS PASSED	LAST ACTIVE	STATUS	LAST REVIEWED	AIM	TEACHER	ULN
Lara Learner	—	E3	1.0	0.0	2	Today	ACTIVE	Never	—	Theo Teacher	✓
Collins Sanni	ENTRY 1	ENTRY 1	0.0	0.0	0	Never	ACTIVE	Never	—	Theo Teacher	—
Stephen Sanni	ENTRY 2	ENTRY 2	3.4	0.0	0	10 Jun 2026	ACTIVE	Never	—	Theo Teacher	—

Rows per page: 50 | 1–3 of 3 | < 1 / 1 >

Top to bottom:

1. **The three action buttons.** Import CSV, Funding report, and Export ILR. Sections 8, 9, and 10 cover each in detail.
2. **Three tabs.** Cohort (this view), Audit Log, and Stage 5 Pending.
3. **Cohort summary.** A plain English narrative of the reporting period, written by the AI from your real data and cached. Press **Refresh** to regenerate it. Use it as the opening paragraph of a board or funder update.
4. **Filters and Download CSV.** Search by name, filter by status, level, or aim type. Download CSV exports the table as you filtered it.
5. **The cohort table.** One row per learner: starting and current level, **Total GLH**, **Teacher HRS**, scenarios passed, last active, status band, last reviewed, aim, teacher, and a ULN tick.

Reading the hours columns, this matters for funding:

- **Total GLH** includes AI tutor time. It shows the learner's whole learning volume.
- **Teacher HRS** is human contact time only.
- The learner record splits this further into AI, imported, and teacher hours. Only the parts your funding rules allow are ever claimed; AI tutor time is kept out of claims until the funder confirms it may count. The platform enforces this for you, so a bigger Total GLH never inflates a claim by itself.

Status bands: Active means recent practice. Inactive and Dormant mean rising time away; those learners are candidates for a nudge or a teacher message. **Last reviewed** showing **Never** in amber is a prompt: no teacher has logged a review for that learner yet.

3. A learner's record

How to get here: press a learner's name in any table, or sidebar, **Learners**, then the learner.

The screenshot shows the AMBER interface for a learner's record. The header includes the AMBER logo, 'Organisation Admin > Dashboard', and user information 'Oria Admin Organisation Admin'. The left sidebar lists navigation options: OVERVIEW (Dashboard), ESOL (Cohort dashboard, Learners, Invitations, ESOL Teachers), FINANCE (Invoices), COMPLIANCE (Audit log), and ORGANISATION (Settings). The main content area for 'Lara Learner' shows a 'CURRENT LEVEL: ENTRY LEVEL 3' and 'ACTIVE' status. It displays 'TOTAL GUIDED LEARNING HOURS' as 1.5 h, broken down into AI 1.0, Imported 0.0, and Teacher 0.5. A 'Send nudge' button is present. Below this, 'SUGGESTED TEACHERS' are listed, with 'Theo Teacher' as the 'BEST MATCH' and 'CURRENT TEACHER' for 3/150 learners. A tabbed interface shows 'Overview' selected, with other tabs for Sessions, Vocabulary, Stage 3 Objectives, Stage 5 Reviews, Evidence Chain, Compliance Timeline, and Teacher Reviews. The 'Level progression' section indicates no level changes yet. A summary row shows: SCENARIOS PASSED (2), TOTAL GLH (1.5 h, includes AI time), CLAIMABLE GLH (0.5 h, excludes AI time), AI TUTOR HOURS (1.0 h), and TEACHER CONTACT (0.5 h). The 'Recent activity' section lists events like 'TEACHER MESSAGE READ', 'RARPA STAGE3 NEGOTIATED', 'SESSION COMPLETED', 'SESSION STARTED', and another 'TEACHER MESSAGE READ' with timestamps.

The header gives you:

- **Total guided learning hours** with the split underneath: AI, Imported, Teacher. This is the honest hours picture per learner.
- **Send nudge.** One press sends the learner a friendly reminder email. Every nudge is recorded in the audit log.
- **Suggested teachers.** Ranked by fit: level coverage, shared language, specialism, then workload. You decide; every assignment is audited.

The eight tabs

Tab	What it shows
Overview	Level history, key stats, recent activity
Sessions	Every AI session with pass results and durations
Vocabulary	Words retained and words in progress
Stage 3 Objectives	The learner's goals, grouped by level, with source (placement, level change, teacher)
Stage 5 Reviews	The learner's review history (see the note in section 6)
Evidence Chain	The audit backbone, explained below
Compliance Timeline	Every compliance event for this learner in order
Teacher Reviews	Every review teachers have logged, with durations

The Evidence Chain tab, your audit view

AMBER

Organisation Admin > Dashboard

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Organisation Admin

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Lara Learner

CURRENT LEVEL: ENTRY LEVEL 3 • ACTIVE

TOTAL GUIDED LEARNING HOURS 1.5 h
AI 1.0 - Imported 0.0 - Teacher 0.5

Send nudge

SUGGESTED TEACHERS

Ranked by fit — level coverage, shared language, specialism, then workload. You decide; every assignment is audited.

Show all (1)

Theo Teacher

BEST MATCH

CURRENT TEACHER

3/150 learners

Teaches Entry 3

Overview

Sessions

Vocabulary

Stage 3 Objectives

Stage 5 Reviews

Evidence Chain

Compliance Timeline

Teacher Reviews

Evidence chain

12 captured 2 awaiting human sign-off

Each data point captured during a session, mapped to its RARPA stage and ILR fields. Points marked needs sign-off are formative until a human confirms them at Stage 5 — the honesty gate.

Beat 2 — Roleplay

DATA POINT	RARPA	ILR FIELDS	COUNT	STATUS
recast_uptake	Stage 4 (formative)	—	2	Formative
skill_codes	Stage 4 (formative)	—	2	Formative
teaching_mode_and_transitions	Stage 4 (formative)	—	2	Formative
turn_score	Stage 4 (formative)	—	2	Needs sign-off (0/2)
vocabulary_items_used	Stage 4 (formative)	—	2	Formative

Beat 3 — Complete

DATA POINT	RARPA	ILR FIELDS	COUNT	STATUS
session_complete	Stage 4 (formative)	—	1	Formative
session_summary	Stage 4 summary feeding Stage 5	—	1	Formative

Every data point captured during a session is recorded at the moment it happens and mapped to its RARPA stage and ILR fields. The badges at the top count the records and, crucially, how many still **await human sign off**.

How to read the STATUS column:

- **Formative.** Supporting evidence. It stands on its own and needs no approval: vocabulary used, skill codes, teaching mode changes.
- **Needs sign-off (0/2).** These rows are AI judgements, for example the per turn scores. They are formative until a human confirms the learner's achievement at Stage 5. This is the honesty gate: nothing the AI scores can enter a funding claim by itself.
- **Confirmed.** A human has signed off, so the record can support a summative claim.

If an auditor asks "where did this ILR field come from", this tab is the answer, per learner, per session, per data point.

4. Enrolling learners one at a time, invitations

How to get here: sidebar, **Invitations**.

The screenshot displays the AMBER Invitations page. The sidebar on the left contains the following menu items: Overview (Dashboard), ESOL (Cohort dashboard, Learners, Invitations), ESOL Teachers, Finance (Invoices), Compliance (Audit log), and Organisation (Settings). The main content area is titled 'Invitations' and includes a subtitle 'Track and resend invitation links for new learners.' and a '+ New invitation' button. Below this is a table with two rows, each showing a 'Generic invitation link' with an expiration date and time. Each row has a 'Pending' status, a 'Copy link' button, and a 'Revoke' button.

Invitation Link	Status	Copy link	Revoke
Generic invitation link Expires 26 Aug 2026, 00:06	Pending	Copy link	Revoke
Generic invitation link Expires 25 Aug 2026, 23:54	Pending	Copy link	Revoke

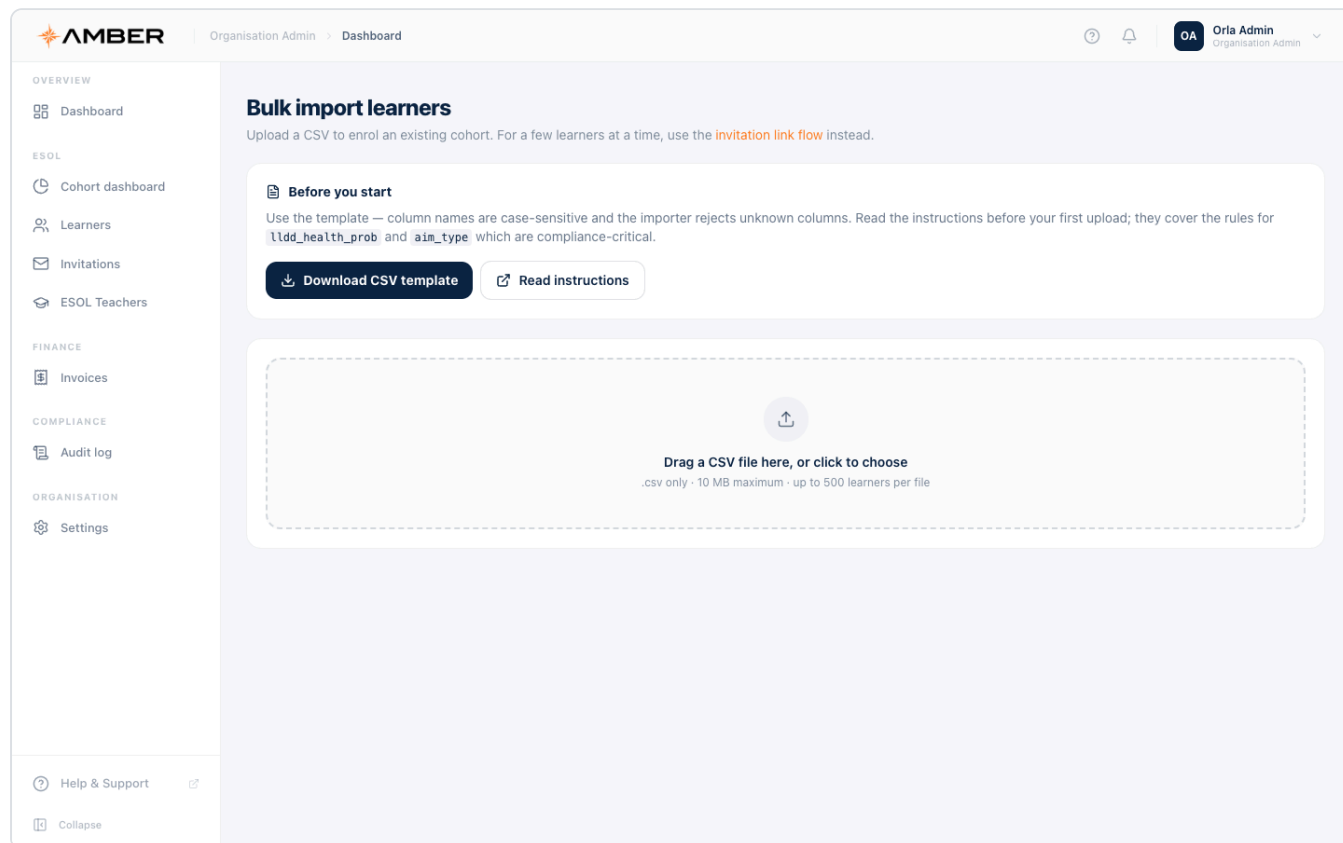
Step by step

1. Optionally enter the learner's email and expected level; set how many days the invite stays valid.
2. Press create. Amber generates a unique join link (and emails it if you gave an address).
3. The learner opens the link and completes the five step join form in their own language.
4. The table below tracks every invite: pending, used, expired. You can **remind** (resend) or **revoke** (cancel) any pending invite.

Good to know: the invite carries your organisation, so learners who join through it land in your cohort automatically.

5. Enrolling a whole cohort, bulk import

How to get here: cohort dashboard, **Import CSV**, or sidebar via the Learners area.



Step by step

1. Press **Download CSV template**. Column names are case sensitive and unknown columns are rejected, so always start from the template.
 2. Press **Read instructions** before your first upload. Two columns are compliance critical and the instructions cover their rules: `l1dd_health_prob` and `aim_type`.
 3. Fill the template, one row per learner, up to 500 learners and 10 MB per file.
 4. Drag the file in. Amber validates **every row individually** and reports problems by row number, so one bad row never sinks the file. Rows with a postcode that needs manual funding routing import with a warning rather than failing.
 5. Fix any reported rows and upload just the corrections.
-

6. Stage 5, confirming an achievement

This is the most important approval in the system, so it gets the full treatment. **Nothing becomes an achieved outcome in your funding data until you confirm it here.**

The journey to your desk

1. The learner completes their level and submits a short **self assessment**, their own voice on their progress.
2. The AI writes a **summary of the evidence**: readiness, key achievements, and a plain English narrative.
3. The **teacher signs off** their side from the learner record.
4. The review then waits for **you**. Until you act, the learner's ILR record stays "continuing", never "achieved". The export notes call this a withheld achievement.

The review page

How to get here: from the learner's record, or directly at the review link in your notification.

 Organisation Admin > Dashboard

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← Back to learner

Stage 5 review — Entry Level 3

Lara Learner · ULN 8001234567

Ready for your confirmation

 **Learner's self-assessment**

OVERALL CONFIDENCE

 **High confidence**

PER-OBJECTIVE RATINGS

By week 6, I can give and respond to advice in a roleplay using should and have to.

 Confident

By the end of the unit, I can describe a past event in six or more spoken sentences using the past simple.

 Confident

Develop functional English communication skills at Entry Level 3

 Confident

LEARNER'S NEXT-STEPS PREFERENCE

Submitted 18/08/2026, 09:15:00

 **AI tutor summary**

READINESS FOR NEXT LEVEL

 **High**

SUMMARY

Lara has completed her Entry 3 pathway with steady, confident progress. She opens conversations politely, describes past events accurately, and recovers well when she does not understand. Her GP appointment and housing sessions show she can handle real UK situations independently. She is ready to be stretched at the next level.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Booked a GP appointment unprompted, giving her details clearly
- Used the past simple correctly across two consecutive sessions
- Retained 5 core vocabulary items including appointment and prescription

Generated 18/08/2026, 10:15:00 · Tokens in/out: 2400/320

Confirm Stage 5 review

AGREED NEXT STEPS *

Describe the plan agreed with the learner — e.g. consolidate at this level for two weeks, then attempt Entry Level 3 placement.

0 / 2000

OPTIONAL OVERRIDE (ADVANCE TO LEVEL)

(no override)

The level change has already happened. This field records your final decision for the audit log — it doesn't create a new level change.

Confirm and lock

Write the agreed next steps to enable confirm.

The badge in the corner tells you the state: **Ready for your confirmation** means the self assessment and teacher sign off are in place. The two panels give you everything you need to judge:

- **Learner's self assessment.** Overall confidence plus a rating against every one of their goals.
- **AI tutor summary.** Readiness for the next level, a narrative summary, and key achievements drawn from real sessions. This is advisory. You are the decision.

Confirming

1. Write the **agreed next steps**, the plan agreed with the learner. This field is required; the confirm button stays disabled until you write it.
2. The **optional override** lets you record a different level decision for the audit trail. The caption explains that the level change itself has already happened; this field records your final judgement.
3. Press **Confirm and lock**.

What happens when you confirm, all of it recorded:

- The review is stamped with your name and the time, permanently. It cannot be edited afterwards, which is what makes it evidence.
- The learner's achievement becomes eligible for the ILR export as an achieved outcome. Before this moment the export withholds it.
- The audit log records the confirmation.

Consider these scenarios before pressing confirm:

- *The self assessment says low confidence but the AI says high readiness.* Talk to the teacher and the learner first. Confirming is your judgement, not a formality.
- *No teacher sign off yet.* The state badge will say so. Chase the teacher rather than confirming around them.
- *You disagree with the level.* Use the override field so the audit trail carries your decision, and speak to the teacher about the pathway.
- *You are not ready to decide.* Do nothing. Leaving a review pending is always safe; the learner keeps practising and no claim is made.

The Stage 5 Pending tab

The cohort dashboard has a **Stage 5 Pending** tab intended to list every review waiting for you in one place. In the current release the list itself is still being wired up, so reviews are reached from your notifications or the learner's record. The confirm flow itself is fully live.

7. Teachers and assignment

How to get here: sidebar, **ESOL Teachers**.

AMBER

Organisation Admin > Dashboard

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OA Orla Admin
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Teacher assignment

🔗 Auto-assign unassigned

Manage the teachers attached to your organisation and the learners each of them looks after. New learners are auto-matched on registration; the button places any who are still unassigned.

↔ Bulk reassign

Move every learner currently assigned to one teacher onto another. Useful when a teacher leaves the organisation or hits capacity.

FROM TEACHER

TO TEACHER

— Select —

↔

— Select —

Move learners

Teachers in your organisation

TEACHER	EMAIL	LEARNERS	UTILISATION	ACTIONS
Theo Teacher Entry 2 Entry 3 French Arabic Exam prep	seed-qa-teacher@example.com	3 / 150	2%	Assign

- Add teachers to your organisation and remove them when they leave.
- Assign learners to teachers. The **suggested teachers** panel on each learner record ranks candidates by fit; assignment is always your decision and always audited.
- A learner needs an assigned teacher for the priority queue, messaging, and reviews to work, so assign at enrolment.

8. Exporting the ILR return

How to get here: cohort dashboard, **Export ILR**.

Export ILR

Generate an ESFA-format ILR CSV (and JSON companion) for the chosen academic year and reporting period. Cached exports return instantly — tick "Force refresh" to rebuild from current data.

ACADEMIC YEAR

YYYYYY format. Defaults to the current UK academic year.

PERIOD START

PERIOD END

☐ Force refresh (skip cache)

Step by step

1. Check the **academic year** (defaults to the current UK academic year) and the reporting period dates.
2. Leave **Force refresh** unticked normally. Exports are cached for speed; tick it only when you need the export rebuilt from this minute's data.
3. Press **Generate**. You receive the ESFA format CSV plus a JSON companion file that documents what was exported and why.

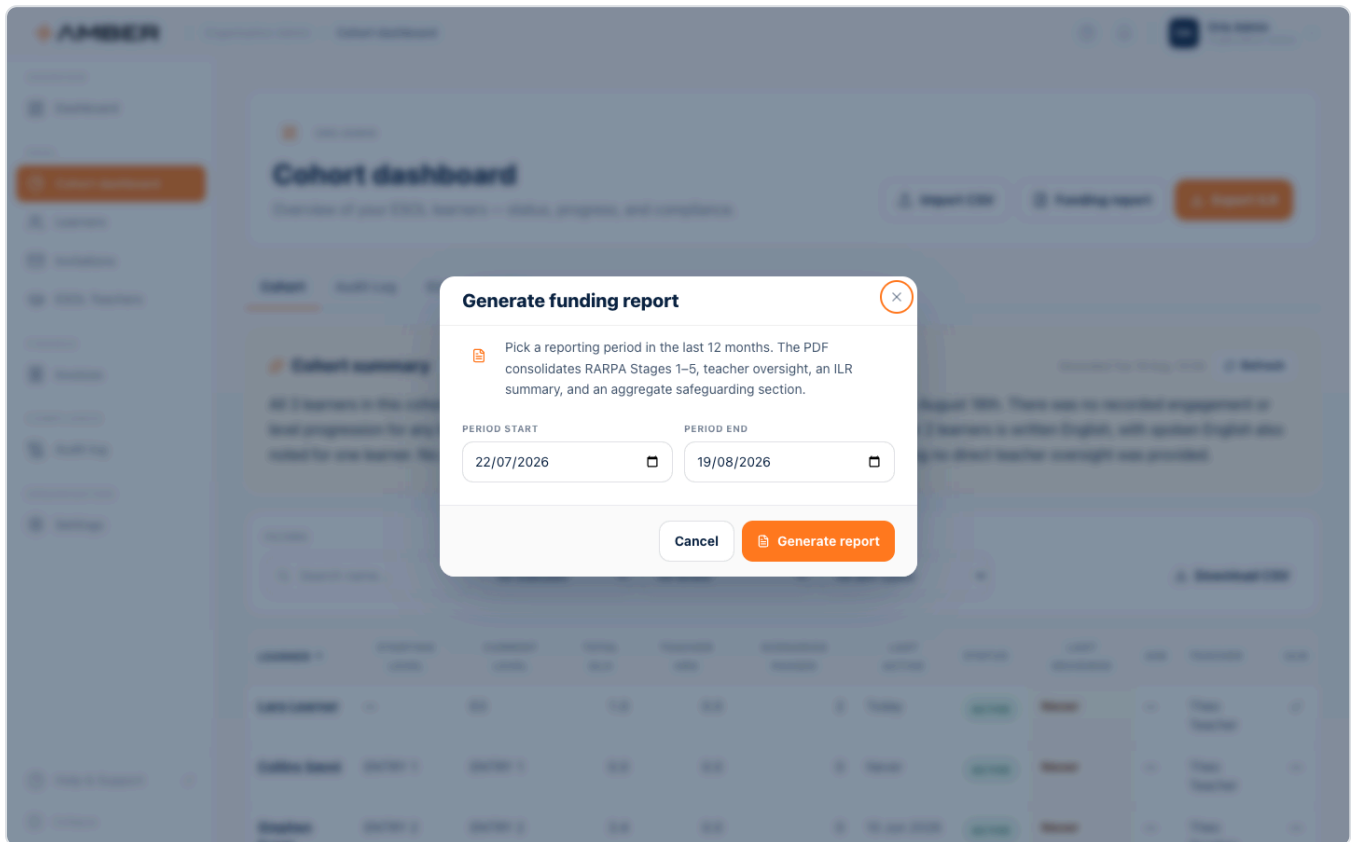
What the export does for you, and what it refuses to do:

- Validates every row and reports warnings rather than exporting silently wrong data. Rows with problems the rules can correct are fixed and noted; rows that cannot be exported are suppressed with a reason.
- **Withholds unconfirmed achievements.** A learner who passed with the AI but has no confirmed Stage 5 review exports as continuing, with a note explaining the withheld achievement. Confirm the Stage 5 review and the next export includes the achievement.
- **Keeps AI hours out of the claim.** Claim driving hours come from teacher contact and imported prior learning. AI tutor time is reported for reconciliation but never summed into a claim, pending funder confirmation.

Before you submit to the funder, read the companion JSON's warning list. It is your pre submission checklist.

9. The funding report

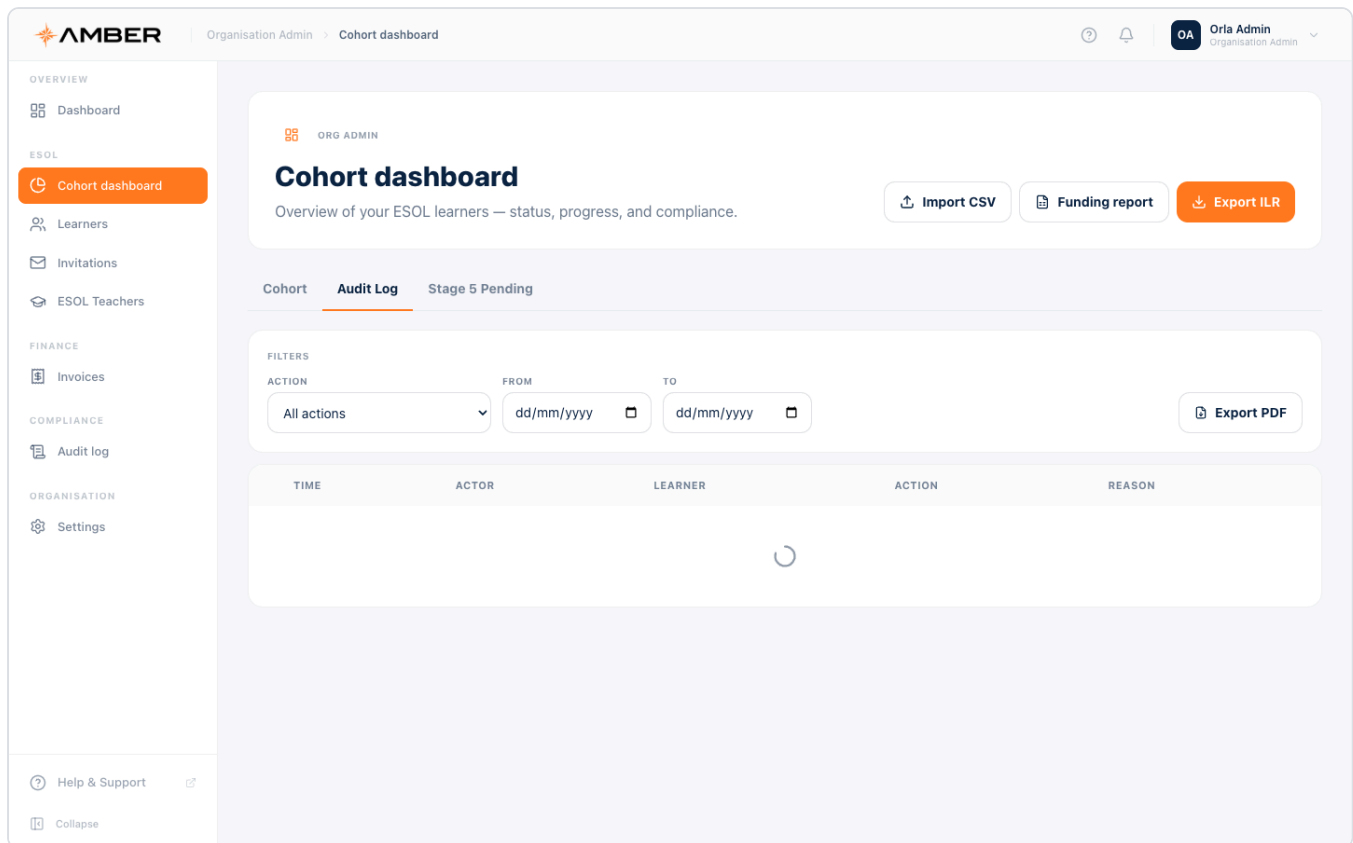
How to get here: cohort dashboard, **Funding report**.



Pick a reporting period within the last 12 months and press **Generate report**. The PDF consolidates RARPA Stages 1 to 5, teacher oversight, an ILR summary, and an aggregate safeguarding section. This is the document to hand an auditor or a funder alongside the ILR CSV.

10. The audit log

How to get here: sidebar, **Audit log**, or the Audit Log tab on the cohort dashboard.



Every compliance relevant event in your organisation, in order: who, what, when, and why. Sessions, level changes, exports, confirmations, nudges, assignments. The log is append only. Nobody, including Amber, can edit history. Use the search and filters to answer any "what happened here" question without asking a developer.

11. Invoices and settings

- **Invoices** (sidebar, Invoices): your billing history with Amber.
- **Settings** (sidebar, Settings): your organisation profile.

12. Amber on your phone

The cohort dashboard works at phone size, so you can check status and confirm reviews away from your desk:



Loading your dashboard...

13. If something goes wrong

Problem	What to do
A learner's achievement is missing from the ILR export	Almost always the Stage 5 review is unconfirmed. Open the review, confirm it, export again. The export notes name every withheld achievement.
The CSV import rejected my file	Start from the downloaded template; column names are case sensitive. Fix the rows named in the report and upload just those.
An invite expired before the learner used it	Press remind to resend, or create a fresh invite.
The cohort summary looks out of date	It is cached. Press Refresh next to it.
A learner shows Never reviewed	No teacher review has been logged. Check the teacher assignment and ask the teacher to log their contact.
I confirmed a Stage 5 review by mistake	Confirmations are permanent by design. Contact Amber support; the audit trail preserves the full history either way.

Terms like ILR, RARPA, GLH, and aim type are explained in the [glossary](#).